

TOMA Engineering Inc.

Company Profile and Proposal Background

Document purpose: Internal reference for proposal development, pursuit strategy, team selection and corporate positioning.

Company Overview

TOMA Engineering Inc. is an Ontario-based multidisciplinary consulting engineering firm specializing in municipal infrastructure, land development, water and wastewater systems, transportation infrastructure, stormwater management and construction services.

Founded in 2008, TOMA has grown to approximately 85 employees working from offices in Wasaga Beach, Barrie and Kitchener, Ontario.

The firm primarily serves municipalities, public agencies, developers and institutional clients throughout Ontario.

TOMA's practice has developed around projects where civil infrastructure systems intersect: roads with underground servicing, municipal infrastructure renewal, growth-related servicing, complex grading and drainage, and projects requiring close coordination between owners, developers, utilities, regulators and construction contractors.

Core Services

TOMA provides services through the full project lifecycle, including:

- feasibility and infrastructure planning;
- municipal servicing studies;
- preliminary and detailed design;
- road reconstruction and rehabilitation;
- water distribution infrastructure;
- sanitary sewer infrastructure;
- stormwater management and drainage;
- pumping stations;
- land development engineering;
- grading and site servicing;

- environmental and regulatory coordination;
- utility coordination;
- tender and contract-document preparation;
- cost estimating;
- construction administration;
- site inspection and contract observation;
- asset-condition assessment;
- constructability review;
- project management; and
- multidisciplinary design coordination.

TOMA frequently acts as prime consultant and manages specialist subconsultants where surveying, geotechnical, environmental, hydrogeological, structural or other specialized services are required.

Markets

TOMA's principal markets are:

Municipal Infrastructure

Roads, watermains, sanitary sewers, stormwater systems, pumping stations and infrastructure renewal.

Land Development

Residential, commercial and mixed-use developments, including subdivision servicing, grading, stormwater management and municipal approvals.

Water and Wastewater

Linear infrastructure, pumping stations, capacity improvements, condition assessment and system rehabilitation.

Transportation and Complete Streets

Municipal road reconstruction, intersection improvements, active transportation facilities, accessibility and streetscape integration.

Public Facilities and Sites

Municipal and institutional sites requiring civil servicing, accessibility, grading, drainage and multidisciplinary coordination.

How TOMA Works

TOMA's culture is strongly technical but deliberately practical.

The firm expects project managers to remain involved throughout delivery rather than transferring responsibility to junior staff after award. Senior technical staff are expected to participate at important design decisions and reviews without unnecessarily increasing project-management overhead.

TOMA generally prefers small, accountable project teams supported by specialist resources as needed.

The firm's project-management philosophy emphasizes:

Understand the problem before designing the solution.

TOMA encourages teams to investigate existing conditions, clarify assumptions and identify critical interfaces early.

Make decisions visible.

Major technical decisions should be documented with their rationale, implications and outstanding risks so clients understand how a project is progressing.

Design for construction.

Constructability is considered throughout design rather than treated as a final-stage review.

Escalate early.

Project managers are expected to advise clients about emerging schedule, scope, cost and technical issues before those issues become urgent.

Avoid unnecessary complexity.

The preferred solution is generally the simplest technically sound solution that meets the client's operational and long-term needs.

Corporate Strengths

Integrated Municipal Infrastructure

TOMA's strongest corporate capability is the integration of road, water, wastewater, drainage, grading and development-servicing requirements within a single design.

The firm is particularly effective on assignments where decisions made by one discipline materially affect another.

For proposals involving road reconstruction and underground infrastructure, Sasha should consider this one of TOMA's strongest potential differentiators.

Constructability

TOMA has substantial construction-phase experience.

Several senior designers and project managers have worked in contract administration or field roles and routinely incorporate construction considerations into design decisions.

The firm's internal design reviews commonly ask:

- Can this actually be constructed as shown?
- How will existing services remain operational?
- What temporary works may be necessary?
- Where are likely utility conflicts?
- What access must be maintained?
- What assumptions could become change orders?
- Are quantities, drawings and specifications consistent?

When relevant, this experience should be positioned as a means of reducing construction uncertainty—not as a generic claim that TOMA produces "constructible designs."

Municipal–Development Interface

Because TOMA works for both municipalities and private developers, its staff understand the different objectives, approval processes, schedules and commercial pressures affecting each side.

This can be particularly valuable where municipal infrastructure must accommodate growth or coordinate with adjacent developments.

TOMA should not characterize itself as representing developer interests when working for a municipality. The benefit is that the team understands development processes and can anticipate coordination issues.

Senior Staff Accessibility

TOMA is large enough to assemble multidisciplinary teams but small enough that senior technical staff remain accessible to clients and project managers.

This is a legitimate positioning point where an RFP suggests that responsiveness, continuity or senior involvement matters.

Avoid generic statements such as "our principals are involved in every project." Instead, proposals should identify exactly **who will remain involved, when and why**.

Project Management Approach

TOMA's typical municipal project-management framework includes:

Project initiation

Confirm objectives, scope, responsibilities, communication protocols, schedule and critical decisions.

Investigation

Gather and validate available information before relying upon it for design.

Risk and interface identification

Identify issues that cross disciplines, organizations or project phases.

Progressive design

Use defined design milestones with increasingly detailed technical, cost and constructability reviews.

Decision management

Identify decisions required from the client and provide sufficient information for timely resolution.

Quality management

Apply discipline reviews, multidisciplinary coordination reviews and independent senior review where warranted.

Construction continuity

Where possible, maintain involvement of key design personnel through tender and construction.

Quality Management

TOMA maintains an internal quality-management system based on four principles:

1. The person performing the work is responsible for its technical accuracy.
2. Technical work is reviewed by an appropriately experienced person.

3. Interfaces between disciplines require explicit coordination.
4. Critical deliverables receive independent senior review.

For significant multidisciplinary projects, TOMA typically establishes a project-specific Quality Plan identifying:

- deliverables;
- responsible designers;
- technical reviewers;
- independent reviewers;
- review milestones;
- interdisciplinary coordination requirements; and
- document-control procedures.

Sasha should distinguish between **technical checking** and **independent QA/QC** when an RFP asks for that distinction.

Health, Safety and Field Work

TOMA maintains corporate health and safety procedures for field investigations, construction observation and site visits.

Project-specific safety planning is undertaken where field conditions warrant it.

TOMA staff performing field activities are trained for the work they undertake, and specialist subconsultants remain responsible for their own applicable health and safety programs while complying with project requirements.

Accessibility

TOMA's municipal design practice incorporates applicable accessibility requirements into public infrastructure design.

The firm also has internal procedures for preparing accessible digital documents when required by clients.

When an RFP contains specific accessibility standards, those requirements should govern the proposal rather than relying on generic corporate statements.

Sustainability

TOMA does not position itself as a sustainability consultancy.

Instead, sustainability should be discussed where it is inherent in sound engineering decisions, including:

- extending useful infrastructure life;
- avoiding unnecessary replacement;
- stormwater management;
- low-impact development;
- efficient use of materials;
- consideration of lifecycle implications;
- minimizing construction waste;
- designing infrastructure that can be maintained effectively; and
- coordinating future infrastructure needs to reduce premature reconstruction.

Avoid unsupported claims about carbon reductions or environmental benefits unless project evidence exists.

Client Service Philosophy

TOMA's preferred client relationship is collaborative and candid.

Project managers are expected to tell clients when:

- an assumption needs verification;
- a requested approach creates technical risk;
- scope is changing;
- additional investigation would reduce uncertainty;
- schedule expectations may not be realistic; or
- a simpler alternative may provide better value.

TOMA does not define good client service as simply agreeing with the client.

The firm's objective is to help clients make informed decisions and then execute those decisions reliably.

Geographic Experience

TOMA's principal experience is in Ontario.

The firm has worked for upper-tier, lower-tier and single-tier municipalities as well as private-sector clients.

Particular experience exists in communities experiencing growth where existing municipal infrastructure must be renewed while accommodating new development.

TOMA should not claim specialized local knowledge of a municipality unless supported by actual project records or client history.

Proposed Corporate Differentiators

These are **potential differentiators**, not automatic proposal claims. Sasha should determine whether each is relevant and supportable for the pursuit.

1. Infrastructure integration

TOMA is strongest where roads, water, wastewater, drainage and development requirements have to work as one system.

2. Design informed by construction

Construction experience influences design decisions before tender.

3. Municipal and development perspective

TOMA understands both municipal infrastructure objectives and the mechanics of development servicing.

4. Senior continuity

Key senior personnel remain involved at critical decisions throughout delivery.

5. Practical engineering

TOMA favours clear, maintainable and constructible solutions over unnecessary complexity.

Areas Where TOMA Should Be Careful

TOMA should not try to present itself as the largest firm or as having unlimited specialist resources.

Against larger competitors, the stronger argument is:

the right people, direct accountability and integrated delivery.

TOMA also should not claim to be a specialist in every technical discipline.

Where specialist expertise is legitimately required, the firm's strength is assembling and managing an appropriate specialist while retaining responsibility for overall integration.

Sasha should never hide a capability gap behind vague corporate language.

Competitive Position

Internal assumption

TOMA most commonly competes against:

- large national multidisciplinary engineering firms;
- established regional municipal engineering consultants; and
- smaller local civil engineering firms.

Against large firms, TOMA should emphasize senior accessibility, team continuity, responsiveness and practical integration.

Against smaller firms, TOMA should emphasize multidisciplinary depth, quality-management processes, capacity and experience delivering larger or more complicated assignments.

Against similar regional firms, differentiation must come from the **specific team, project evidence and approach**, not general corporate claims.

Proposal Writing Guidance

When writing about TOMA, Sasha should avoid boilerplate such as:

TOMA Engineering is a leading multidisciplinary consulting engineering firm committed to providing innovative, sustainable and cost-effective solutions.

That tells an evaluator almost nothing.

Prefer evidence-led positioning:

TOMA's municipal team combines road, water, wastewater and stormwater design with construction-phase experience, allowing key servicing and constructability decisions to be resolved within the design team rather than passed between separate disciplines.

Corporate claims should generally be followed by evidence.

Claim → Evidence → Relevance to this assignment.

Evidence Rules for Sasha

This company profile provides **corporate context and positioning guidance**.

It is not evidence that a particular project was completed or that an individual possesses particular experience.

When preparing proposals:

- use Phil for project-specific evidence;
- use personnel records for individual qualifications and experience;
- use pursuit records for previous proposal strategies and outcomes;
- use the applicable RFP for client requirements;
- use this company profile to understand TOMA's corporate positioning and operating philosophy.

If a statement in this profile conflicts with an authoritative project record, personnel record or current client requirement, use the authoritative source.

Internal Summary for Sasha

When deciding how to position TOMA, begin with the client's problem—not the company's capabilities.

Identify the issues that matter most to successful delivery. Then determine which TOMA strengths, people and project evidence genuinely address those issues.

Do not force every corporate differentiator into every proposal.

A strong TOMA proposal should leave the evaluator thinking:

They understand what could make this project difficult, they have people who have dealt with those problems before, and their approach gives us confidence that they will manage them well.

That is the corporate impression TOMA wants its proposals to create.